

Hydra's Vault — Codebase Audit & Motion Restoration Report

Project: Hydra's Vault Portfolio
Stack: React 19, Vite 6, Tailwind CSS v4, Framer Motion, Lenis

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Report Status: Updated — Restoration Complete

1. Executive Summary & Root Cause Analysis

During recent refactoring to standardize button tokens and eliminate duplicate headings, several dynamic UI effects—including background motion canvas, gradient blobs, card tilt effects, and emerald hover glows—became flat or non-responsive.

Primary Cause

Replacing hardcoded glassmorphism classes (**bg-slate-900/60**, **backdrop-blur-md**, **border-white/10**) with solid theme tokens stripped out backdrop filters and transition properties. Additionally, solid opaque section backgrounds masked the ambient mesh and canvas layers rendering underneath.

Secondary Cause (Discovered During Audit)

~~Ambient-blob-keyframes~~ and ~~cursor-spotlight~~ were referenced in `src/index.css`, but all of these were deleted from `src/index.css` during the token-standardization pass. The blobs therefore rendered transparent and inert, which is why the background motion appeared completely flat.

2. Component Modification Audit

File / Component	Previous State	Recent Modification	Visual Impact
`useLenis.ts` / `App.tsx`	Continuous inertia scrolling	Added modal check (`lenis.stop()`)	Fixed (Scroll locks correctly)
`AboutSection.tsx`	"MANY HEADS. ONE UNIFIED VISION."	Updated to "MANY HEADS. ONE ORIGIN."	Fixed (Heading collision resolved)
`src/index.css`	Glass & glow classes removed	Restored <code>.ambient-blob</code> keyframes, <code>.cursor-spotlight</code> , blob palette vars, <code>.glass-card</code> , <code>.glass-hover</code>	Restored (Blur, glow & ambient motion back)
Ambient Canvas / Hero	Blobs rendered invisible (CSS stripped)	Re-added drift animations + <code>--blob-*</code> / <code>--spot-glow</code> vars	Restored (Organic motion visible)
Section Wrappers	No layer between content & blobs	Added <code>bg-[var(--bg-canvas)]/80 backdrop-blur-sm</code>	Restored (Motion reads behind glass)
Cards & Interactive Elements	Inline transitions & hover glow stripped	Re-applied glass surfaces + emerald hover glow	Restored (Lift, blur & glow active)

Restored (Tactile feedback)

- [illegible]

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- Added `ambient-backlight` (light animation) (`background-color: linear-gradient(to top, #000000 49%, #000000 49%, #000000 51%, #000000 51%, #000000 53%, #000000 53%, #000000 55%, #000000 55%, #000000 57%, #000000 57%, #000000 59%, #000000 59%, #000000 61%, #000000 61%, #000000 63%, #000000 63%, #000000 65%, #000000 65%, #000000 67%, #000000 67%, #000000 69%, #000000 69%, #000000 71%, #000000 71%, #000000 73%, #000000 73%, #000000 75%, #000000 75%, #000000 77%, #000000 77%, #000000 79%, #000000 79%, #000000 81%, #000000 81%, #000000 83%, #000000 83%, #000000 85%, #000000 85%, #000000 87%, #000000 87%, #000000 89%, #000000 89%, #000000 91%, #000000 91%, #000000 93%, #000000 93%, #000000 95%, #000000 95%, #000000 97%, #000000 97%, #000000 99%, #000000 99%, #000000 100%)`, with `parallax` for light and `fade` for dark
- Added `glass-card` — obsidian glass surface (`background-filter: blur(16px)`), hairline (`border-white/10`, `border-radius: 10px`)
- Softened `glass-elevation` shadows, added `hover` emerald border (`rgba(16, 185, 129, 0.5)`) + glow bloom `0 0 25px`

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Applied `bg-[var(--bg-canvas)]/80 backdrop-blur-sm` to all six section wrappers so the ambient mesh stays visible behind a soft canvas tint:

`ContactSection.tsx`

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- ## 4.4.5.2 Motion Hooks Re-Enabled

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`VoiceOverSection.tsx:272`

All use `whileHover={{ scale: 1.02, y: -2 }} whileTap={{ scale: 0.98 }}`.

5. Verification

- `npm run build` - Passed (No errors in function build typescript) - none (`AmbientBackground.tsx:26`).
No build opaque section backgrounds remain (e.g. `type=button` search clear).